

W H A L E C L A S S

Circle Time Guide

Everything you need, one page per day

Family Members

Week 11

Week of Nov 2–6

13 minutes a day

ages 2.5–6

English learners





Week 11 · Week Overview

Family Members
Print · laminate · ring-bind · hold this all week

5 words they'll own by Friday →

family

mum

dad

sister

love

Littles (2.5–3)

One word + a gesture is a win: **"Mum!"** (pat your chest), **"Dad!"** (lift both hands up high), **"Love!"** (both hands over your heart, then blow a kiss).

Bigs (4–6)

Sentence frames: **"This is my family."**

"This is my brother / my sister."

"Families are different."

"I help my family."

The week at a glance

MON	Who's in My Family?	your own family photo in a frame, in the Magic Box; every child's family photo in a basket (th...
TUE	My Mum · Big to Small	one baby's sock in the Magic Box; a set of nesting dolls (or five family figures, tallest to s...
WED	My Dad & Grandma	grandma's glasses (or her scarf) in the Magic Box; a cloth big enough to hide a whole child be...
THU	Brother & Sister	two dolls, one big and one small, in the Magic Box; a baby doll; the doll corner set up with a...
FRI	I Love My Family + Big Review	the whole-class photo and the folded family-tree cloth in the Magic Box, with every prop from...

2 MIN

Magic Box hook



4 MIN

Teach the words



3 MIN

Song · today's verse



3 MIN

Game · move it



1 MIN

Whisper-shout close

Weekly rituals — use these every single day

Attention grabber: Teacher: **"One, two, three — eyes on me!"** · Kids: **"One, two — eyes on you!"**

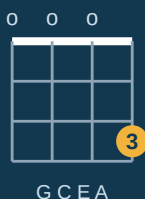
The Magic Box: any box with a lid. Chant it, shake it, sniff it, peek dramatically — the day's key prop lives inside.

The two-tier rule: never make a little produce a sentence, and never let a big get away with one word.

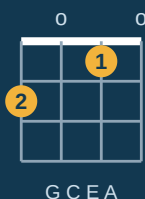
Whisper → shout close: calms them down, then releases them — every single closing.

Teacher-fails-on-purpose: once a day, get it wrong and let them correct you — the correction shout is the loudest language of the day.

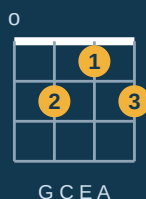
One song a week: same chorus at every circle, one new verse each morning, the whole song on Friday.



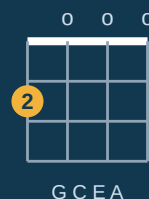
C



F



G7



Am

Uke quick-ref

Strum: Down · Down · Down-Up ("sing — song — sing-a"). Can't manage it yet? Four slow downs per bar works fine — the kids only hear the fun.

The song needs only **C · F · G7 · Am**.

MONDAY

Who's in My Family?

Today's words: **family**

Grab: your own family photo in a frame, in the Magic Box; every child's family photo in a basket (the ones you asked the parents for last week); the home character card.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

Today the box is **flat and heavy**. Hold it on two flat palms. Whole class chants:

EVERYONE "What's in the box? What's in the box?"

Shake it — nothing rattles at all. Peek in, and let your face go soft and slow.

TEACHER "It's flat... it's hard... it's got **glass** on it. Oh. It's my favourite thing in the whole world." (*lift out your own family photo, hold it against your chest for one long beat, then turn it round*)

Hands over hearts. **"Family!"**

4 MIN TEACH • FAMILY

Hold your photo high and go person by person, pointing, one beat each:

This is my **mum**. (*pat your own chest*)

This is my **dad**. (*both hands up high*)

This is my **sister**. (*hand at sister height*)

And this is **me** — look how small I was! (*hand down at knee height*)

Now the photo goes round the circle, ten seconds each: a child points at somebody in it and you name them again. **LITTLES** say the one word **"Family!"** or **"Mum!"** **BIGS** take the frame: **"This is your mum."**

Then the basket. Each child's own photo comes out, they come and fetch it, and they name **one** person in it. Every photo gets the same warm line from you: *"what a lovely family."*

Teacher fails: point at your own **dad** in the photo and announce "...and this is the **baby**." Nod, very pleased with yourself. Wait. Lay the **home** card beside the photo. Tell them once: home means *home* and *family* — one word for both. Leave it there; no drilling.

3 MIN GAME • WHO'S IN MY FAMILY?

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" Every child sits with their photo on their knees, face down until it's their turn.

TEACHER "Stand up... hold it HIGH... who is this?" (*go round the circle, one child at a time*)

LITTLES point and say one word: **"Mum!"** **BIGS** give the sentence: **"This is my mum."** and if they can, **"This is my baby brother."**

Go all the way round; everybody stands up once. The only comment anybody's photo gets is yours, and it is the same one every time.

If a photo didn't come, that child **draws** their family on a card there and then, and it goes on Friday's tree exactly like everyone else's. Never leave a child standing with nothing in their hands.

1 MIN CLOSE

Photos held flat against chests. Whisper → normal → shout:

EVERYONE "Mum... dad... SISTER! I LOVE MY FAMILY!" (*photos lifted right up over their heads on the shout*)

Got 3 spare minutes? *The Family Book* (Todd Parr) — every page is a different family. By page four they will be shouting "that's a family too!" at you.

♪ TODAY'S SONG MOMENT • I LOVE MY FAMILY chorus → Monday's verse → chorus

CHORUS

C Mum and Dad and **F** baby **C** too, (*one finger up for each*)

F Grandma, **C** Grandpa — I **G7** love you! **C** (*blow a kiss*)

C This is my **F** family, big and **C** small, (*arms wide, then hands close*)

F And I **C** love them, **G7** love them **C** all! (*hands to heart, then hug yourself*)

MONDAY • FAMILY

C Family, family, one, two, three, (*three fingers up, one at a time*)

G7 Everybody here **C** loves me! (*hands to heart*)

The one song of the week — same chorus at every circle, one new verse each morning. It is also a counting song: one finger for mum, one for dad, one for baby. Chords and the full sheet are on the Song tab.

TUESDAY

My Mum • Big to Small

Today's words: **mum** (family comes back every day)

Grab: one **baby's sock** in the Magic Box; a set of **nesting dolls** (or five family figures, tallest to shortest); a mat with their shadow outlines drawn on it; one of your own shoes; the mum card.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

Today the box weighs **nothing**. Balance it on one finger so they can see. Chant:

EVERYONE "What's in the box? What's in the box?"

Shake it. Silence. Shake it harder. Still silence. Tip it upside down over your palm and one tiny sock falls out.

TEACHER "Whose sock IS this? It's so... **small**." (hold it up on one finger and wait — somebody will say baby)

"A **baby**! And who looks after the baby?" Pat your chest. "**Mum!**"

4 MIN TEACH • MUM

Your shoe goes on the mat, then the baby's sock beside it. Biggest to smallest, out loud:

Dad's shoe — **BIG!** (stamp once)

My shoe — middle. (tap your own foot)

Baby's sock — **tiny**. (hold it up on one finger)

And **Mum**? Mum holds them all. (scoop the whole lot into your two hands)

LITTLES pat their chest and say "**Mum!**" **BIGS** take the frame: "**This is my mum.**" "**My mum looks after the baby.**"

Then the nesting dolls, taken apart one inside the other in front of them — dad, mum, big sister, little brother, baby — counting each one out loud as it appears, then all the way back in again.

Teacher fails: try to fit the **biggest** doll inside the **smallest** one. Squeeze. Frown. Try again, harder. Let them shout at you.

The **mum** card goes down beside yesterday's home. Sing one line of "My Good Mother" — one line only, then stop.

3 MIN GAME • NESTING DOLLS

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" The dolls go in a heap in the middle; the outline mat goes beside them.

TEACHER "**Biggest** first... now who comes next?"

One child at a time picks up a doll and stands it on the outline it fits. **LITTLES** name it as it lands: "**Dad!**" "**Mum!**" "**Baby!**"

BIGS "**The baby is the smallest.**"

Twice through together, then two children do the whole line on their own while the rest of the class watches and checks.

The **outlines are the lesson**. A doll on the wrong shadow looks wrong to the child before anybody says a word — so say nothing.

1 MIN CLOSE

Everybody's hand flat on their own chest. Whisper → normal → shout:

EVERYONE "Mum... mum... **MUM!**" (both arms up into a big hug on the shout)

Got 3 spare minutes? *Are You My Mother?* (P. D. Eastman) — they will say "are you my mother?" with you on every single page.

♪ TODAY'S SONG MOMENT • I LOVE MY FAMILY chorus → Tuesday's verse → chorus

CHORUS

C Mum and Dad and **F** baby **C** too, (one finger up for each)

F Grandma, **C** Grandpa — I **G7** love you! **C** (blow a kiss)

C This is my **F** family, big and **C** small, (arms wide, then hands close)

F And I **C** love them, **G7** love them **C** all! (hands to heart, then hug yourself)

TUESDAY • MUM

C My mum is soft, my mum is kind, (stroke your cheek, then hands to heart)

G7 The nicest mum **C** you'll ever find! (both arms thrown wide)

Sing today's verse *softly*, like a lullaby, and rock while you sing it. The chorus stays big and bouncy — the contrast is what makes them notice the words.

WEDNESDAY

My Dad & Grandma

Today's words: **dad** (family · mum come back)**Grab: grandma's glasses** (or her scarf) in the Magic Box; a cloth big enough to hide a whole child behind; the dad card.**2 MIN** MAGIC BOX HOOK

Today the box gives one small dry rattle. Chant, shake it twice, then peek in for a long time.

EVERYONE "What's in the box? What's in the box?"Lift out the glasses and put them on. Look slowly round the whole circle *over the top of them*, at every face.**TEACHER** "Whose glasses are these? They're my **grandma's**. And do you know what my grandma is? She is my **dad's mum**." *(hold both hands up high)*Both hands up high. **"Dad!"****4 MIN** TEACH · DAD

Stand up for this one. Everybody copies:

My dad is **TALL!** *(stretch right up on tiptoe)*My dad is **strong**. *(both arms up, muscles)*He lifts me **UP...** *(lift an imaginary child high)*...and I never fall! *(catch, and hug)***LITTLES** lift both hands and say **"Dad!"** **BIGS** **"This is my dad." "My dad is tall."**Then the family ladder, drawn in the air with your hands, three levels high: **grandma and grandpa** at the top — **mum and dad** in the middle — **me** at the bottom. Grandma is dad's mum. That is the sentence of the day and it lands with the four- and five-year-olds hard.**Teacher fails:** balance grandma's glasses on your **knees** and peer earnestly through them at the ceiling. "Ah, now I can see my grandma perfectly." Wait.**Chinese moment:** lay the **dad** card down — now home · mum · dad sit in a row; point along and let them say them. Then ask every child **How many people are in your family?** and count it on fingers together. It is the most natural counting work of the year.**3 MIN** GAME · GUESS WHOSE VOICE

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" One child goes behind the cloth. Everyone else is completely silent.

TEACHER "Say hello... **who is that?**" *(the hider says "Hello, hello, hello" — the same three words every time)*Hands up, then the class names the friend. **LITTLES** just point at the right person, and that counts. **BIGS** **"I hear Lily!"**

Six children behind the cloth, then hand the cloth to a Big and let them run it while you sit in the circle.

Same three words every time, always. The moment the hider chooses their own sentence, the class is guessing the **words**, not the **voice** — and the game stops being about family at all.**1 MIN** CLOSE

Hands ready at the shoulders. Whisper → normal → shout:

EVERYONE "Dad... dad... DAD!" *(both arms fly straight up over their heads on the shout)***Got 3 spare minutes?** "My Dad" (Anthony Browne) — read it in Chinese, and let them shout My dad! on every page.♪ **TODAY'S SONG MOMENT · I LOVE MY FAMILY** chorus → Wednesday's verse → chorus**CHORUS****C** Mum and Dad and **F** baby **C** too, *(one finger up for each)***F** Grandma, **C** Grandpa — I **G7** love you! **C** *(blow a kiss)***C** This is my **F** family, big and **C** small, *(arms wide, then hands close)***F** And I **C** love them, **G7** love them **C** all! *(hands to heart, then hug yourself)***WEDNESDAY · DAD****C** My dad is strong, my dad is tall, *(muscles, then stretch up tall)***G7** He lifts me up — **C** I never fall! *(lift high, then catch)*

Actually lift one child on "he lifts me up" if your back allows it. If it doesn't, lift a doll — they laugh just as hard and nobody gets hurt.

THURSDAY

Brother & Sister

Today's words: **sister** (family · mum · dad come back)

Grab: two dolls, one big and one small, in the Magic Box; a baby doll; the doll corner set up with a little table, a bed and a pot; the person card.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

Today the box is **fat**, and something bumps about inside it when you tilt it. Chant, then shake — a soft *knock... knock*.

EVERYONE "What's in the box? What's in the box?"

TEACHER "There's something in here... no. There are **TWO** somethings." (*lift out the big doll, then the small one, and sit them side by side facing the class*)

"This one is **big**. This one is **small**. Same mum. Same dad. Same house. Who are they?"

Arms round yourself in a hug. "**Sister!**" "**Brother!**"

4 MIN TEACH · SISTER

The two dolls do the whole thing in your hands while you say it:

A big one and a small one, (*hold each doll up in turn*)

Same mum, same dad, (*point to one, point to the other, then hug them together*)

We run and we play... (*walk the two dolls along the floor*)

and we **SHARE**. (*pass one doll's cup across to the other*)

LITTLES say the one word: "**Sister!**" or "**Brother!**" **BIGS** "**This is my sister.**" "**I have a big brother.**" "**I share with my sister.**"

Then go round the circle: who has a **sister**? Hands up — count them out loud. Who has a **brother**? Count. Who is the **baby** in their house? Count. It is real information about real people and they are riveted by it.

Teacher fails: hold the two dolls up, one in each hand, and announce sadly "These two have never met. They are complete strangers." Hold the pose. Wait.

The **person** card goes down. one person, two people — count the whole class in Chinese while you're there. Then say each of older brother · older sister · younger brother · younger sister once, pointing at the dolls. Once each, no drilling.

3 MIN GAME · THE FAMILY HOUSE

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" The doll corner is the house; the big doll, the small doll and the baby doll move in.

TEACHER "Who **cooks** the dinner? Who goes to **bed**? Who **helps**?"

Four children at a time take a job and act it — one cooks, one lays the table, one puts the baby to bed, one sweeps the floor.

Everybody else narrates it: "**The sister is cooking!**" **LITTLES** narrate with one word: "**Cook!**"

Two rounds with new children each time, and the fourth job is always **helping** somebody else.

No fixed roles — a boy can be the mum and a girl can be the dad. Say absolutely nothing about it, either way; just let it happen and keep narrating.

1 MIN CLOSE

Everybody's arms wrapped round themselves. Whisper → normal → shout:

EVERYONE "Sister... brother... FAMILY!" (*squeeze the hug tight on the shout*)

Got 3 spare minutes? "My Mum" (Anthony Browne) — the sister book to yesterday's "My Dad". Read the two back to back and they will spot it themselves.

♪ **TODAY'S SONG MOMENT · I LOVE MY FAMILY** chorus → Thursday's verse → chorus

CHORUS

C Mum and Dad and **F** baby **C** too, (*one finger up for each*)

F Grandma, **C** Grandpa — I **G7** love you! **C** (*blow a kiss*)

C This is my **F** family, big and **C** small, (*arms wide, then hands close*)

F And I **C** love them, **G7** love them **C** all! (*hands to heart, then hug yourself*)

THURSDAY · SISTER

Am My sister, my brother, we run and play, (*run on the spot*)

G7 We share our toys **C** (*most of the day!*) (*hand it over, then a shrug — spoken, not sung*)

"(*most of the day!*)" is **spoken**, not sung, in a stage whisper behind your hand. It gets a laugh every single time, and by Friday they say it before you do.

FRIDAY

I Love My Family + Big Review

Today's words: **family** · **mum** · **dad** · **sister** · **love** — the whole week

Grab: the **whole-class photo** and the folded **family-tree cloth** in the Magic Box, with every prop from the week underneath; all the children's photos and a pot of pegs; the awards (print pack page 17); the love card. Saturday is **Winter Begins** — have the dumpling story ready.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

The box comes out fat and bulging and won't quite shut.

TEACHER "Today the box is FULL — it's got our whole WEEK inside it!"

Pull each prop out and hold it up in complete silence. They will supply the word before you can.

Your photo → **"Family!"** The baby's sock → **"Mum!"** Grandma's glasses → **"Dad!"** The two dolls → **"Sister!"**

Last of all, a folded cloth. Shake it right out — a big bare tree with no leaves and no pictures. Everybody waits. Hands over hearts: **"LOVE!"**

4 MIN TEACH · LOVE, THEN THE WHOLE WEEK

Everybody stands. We tell the whole week with our bodies, twice — slow, then fast:

Family — one, two, three! (*three fingers up, one at a time*)

Mum — soft and kind. (*pat your chest*)

Dad — strong and tall! (*arms up high*)

Sister, brother — we play! (*run on the spot*)

And I **LOVE** them all! (*hands over your heart, then blow a kiss*)

LITTLES do the five gestures and shout the five words. **BIGS** owe you a whole sentence for each one: **"This is my family."** **"I help my family."** **"Families are different."**

Teacher fails: on "I love them all", clap both hands over your **ears** instead of your heart, and look delighted with yourself. Hold it. Let them move your hands down.

Chinese moment: the **love** card joins the row — home · mum · dad · person · love, the whole week on the mat. Then tell them: tomorrow is **Winter Begins**, the day winter starts, and in the north we eat dumplings when winter begins — families sit down and eat dumplings together. Fold an imaginary dumpling with them, all twenty pairs of hands.

3 MIN GAME · BUILD THE FAMILY TREE

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" The tree cloth is pegged up on the wall at child height; every child is holding their own photo.

TEACHER "Come and put your family on the tree."

One at a time: peg the photo onto a branch and say one thing about it. **LITTLES** **"My family!"** **BIGS** **"This is my family. This is my mum."**

By the end the tree is covered and every single family in the room is on the wall — and they are all different, and nobody has to say so.

Leave it up. Parents find themselves on it at pick-up time and read the whole week off the wall. That is your parent report done, for free.

1 MIN CLOSE + AWARDS

Every child gets a "You are a STAR!" award to take home with the Winter Begins news. Then, standing in front of the finished tree, with all five gestures:

EVERYONE "Mum... dad... SISTER! I LOVE MY FAMILY!" (*both hands over hearts, then a blown kiss at the tree on the shout*)

Got 3 spare minutes? *The Family Book* (Todd Parr) again — on Monday you read it to them; today they read it to you, in front of the tree.

♪ **TODAY'S SONG MOMENT · I LOVE MY FAMILY** Friday's verse, then the **WHOLE** song, top to bottom

CHORUS

C Mum and Dad and **F** baby **C** too, (*one finger up for each*)

F Grandma, **C** Grandpa — I **G7** love you! **C** (*blow a kiss*)

C This is my **F** family, big and **C** small, (*arms wide, then hands close*)

F And I **C** love them, **G7** love them **C** all! (*hands to heart, then hug yourself*)

FRIDAY · LOVE

C I love you and you love me, (*point out, then at yourself*)

G7 One big family — **C** happy as can be! (*arms round the whole circle*)

The finale: chorus → Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday, Friday → chorus, standing in front of the finished family tree. They learned it one verse a morning without ever noticing, and this run-through is the review of the entire week.

★ I Love My Family

Week 11 theme song
C (0003) · F (2010) · G7 (0212) · Am (2000)

The one song of the week — sung at every circle. Same chorus daily, one new verse each morning, full song on Friday.

CHORUS — SING IT EVERY SINGLE DAY

- C** Mum and Dad and **F** baby **C** too, *(one finger up for each)*
F Grandma, **C** Grandpa — I **G7** love you! **C** *(blow a kiss)*
C This is my **F** family, big and **C** small, *(arms wide, then hands close)*
F And I **C** love them, **G7** love them **C** all! *(hands to heart, then hug yourself)*

MONDAY · FAMILY

- C** Family, family, one, two, three, *(three fingers up, one at a time)*
G7 Everybody here **C** loves me! *(hands to heart)*

TUESDAY · MUM

- C** My mum is soft, my mum is kind, *(stroke your cheek, then hands to heart)*
G7 The nicest mum **C** you'll ever find! *(both arms thrown wide)*

WEDNESDAY · DAD

- C** My dad is strong, my dad is tall, *(muscles, then stretch up tall)*
G7 He lifts me up — **C** I never fall! *(lift high, then catch)*

THURSDAY · SISTER

- Am** My sister, my brother, we run and play, *(run on the spot)*
G7 We share our toys **C** *(most of the day!)* *(hand it over, then a shrug — spoken, not sung)*

FRIDAY · LOVE

- C** I love you and you love me, *(point out, then at yourself)*
G7 One big family — **C** happy as can be! *(arms round the whole circle)*

Strum: Down · Down · Down-Up (“sing — song — sing-a”).

Can't manage it yet? Four slow downs per bar works fine — the kids only hear the fun.

Practice this loop for five minutes tonight: **C** (4 strums) → **F** (4 strums) → **C** → **G7** → **C**. That is the entire chorus. Add **Am** last — it is one finger on the same string as F, so slide **Am** → **F** → **Am** until it stops feeling like a change; you only need it for the first line of Thursday. If your fingers get stuck, put the uke down and do the finger-play instead: the class will not notice, and the actions carry the meaning either way.